

Gotham Consult
Accra · Ghana

October 2026 edition

INVESTOR COUNTRY GUIDE

Ghana Investment Report *2026*

The economy and its five key sectors: the figures, the rules, the opportunities and the risks, with an outlook to 2028. Every number linked to its official source and re-checked every week.

61	5	3	7 October 2026
sourced figures	sector chapters	scenarios to 2028	data as of

01 Economy and investment climate
02 Gold, mining and critical minerals
03 Oil, gas and power
04 Cocoa and agribusiness
05 ICT, industry and real estate
\+ Outlook 2026–2028

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This report is general information compiled from public sources, not investment, legal or tax advice.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Key takeaways

1. **Economy and investment climate**
   Ghana's real GDP grew 6.0% in Q2 2026 (6.2% in H1) with inflation at 5.2% in September and the Bank of Ghana policy rate held at 14.0%, as the country exited its US$3bn IMF programme in July 2026.

2. **Gold, mining and critical minerals**
   Gold drives two-thirds of Ghana's exports as the state resets royalties, ASM trading and licensing rules

3. **Oil and gas, power and renewables**
   Jubilee drilling reverses a six-year oil decline while power-sector finances improve but remain the main investor risk

4. **Cocoa, agribusiness and agro-processing**
   Cocoa earnings rise and financing is moving onshore, as a 50% local-processing mandate begins with the 2026/27 season

5. **ICT and fintech, manufacturing, real estate and logistics**
   ICT leads Ghana's growth and mobile money exceeds GH¢500bn a month, while ports run near capacity and industrial policy has moved from 1D1F to the 24-Hour Economy (24H+) framework

6. **Outlook 2026–2028**
   Base case (55%): Growth stays around 5% as the gold boom cools but ICT, services and oil keep expanding. Inflation drifts back into the Bank of Ghana's 8% ± 2 band as the cedi weakens gradually, so rate cuts are slow. The February 2027 domestic bond repayments are met from the sinking fund.

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ECONOMY SNAPSHOT

Ghana in eight numbers

Growth, prices, rates and reserves. Figures marked Live refresh automatically from the Bank of Ghana and the Ghana Statistical Service.

Real GDP growth Live
6.0 %
Q2 2026 · source

Inflation Live
5.2 %
September 2026 · source

Bank of Ghana policy rate
14.0 %
September 2026 · source

Cedi per US dollar
11.55 GHS
18 September 2026 · source

Gross international reserves
12.0 USD bn
22 September 2026 · source

Merchandise exports, year to date Live
22.44 USD bn
August 2026 · source

Public debt
45.9 % of GDP
End-July 2026 · source

Foreign direct investment
2.62 USD bn
2025, 245 projects · source

FIGURE 1

Where export earnings come from

January–August 2026, USD billion



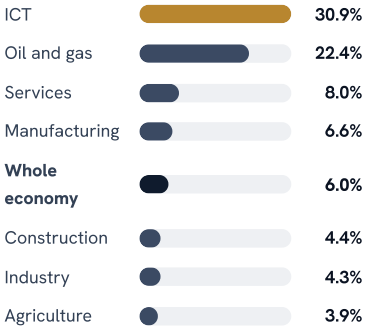
- Gold **USD 14.86bn**
- Cocoa **USD 2.76bn**
- Crude oil **USD 2.42bn**
- Other **USD 2.4bn**

Source: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data (September 2026)

FIGURE 2

What is growing fastest

Real growth, Q2 2026, % year on year

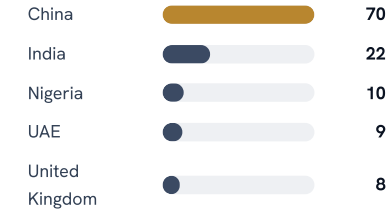


Fishing contracted 24.7%. Source: Ghana Statistical Service, Q2 2026 GDP release, as reported by the Ghana News Agency (9 Sep 2026)

FIGURE 3

Who is investing

New projects registered in 2025, by source country (provisional figures, May 2026)



Source: GIPC, 2025 investment report (reported by Citi Newsroom)

GOTHAM VIEW · AS OF 7 OCTOBER 2026

Outlook 2026–2028: three scenarios

Our view of where Ghana's economy is heading, in three scenarios. Each starts from the official forecasts of the IMF, the World Bank, the Bank of Ghana and the Ministry of Finance, and adds our reading of the drivers that matter most: gold, cocoa, oil, the cedi and public finances.

BASE CASE

55% likely

Growth stays around 5% as the gold boom cools but ICT, services and oil keep expanding. Inflation drifts back into the Bank of Ghana's 8% ± 2 band as the cedi weakens gradually, so rate cuts are slow. The February 2027 domestic bond repayments are met from the sinking fund.

- Gold about US$4,700/oz in 2026 and US$4,300 in 2027 (World Bank, April 2026)
- Cocoa about US$3.80/kg in 2026 and US$4.20 in 2027 (World Bank, April 2026); our assumption of a smaller 2026/27 crop
- Oil output above 100,000 barrels a day in 2026 (our assumption; Jubilee alone above 80,000 b/d per GNPC), rising further as new Jubilee wells come on stream
- Primary surplus of 1.5% of GDP in 2026 (legislated floor) and 0.5% from 2027 (proposed in the 2026 Mid-Year Review; requires amending the PFM Act)

UPSIDE

20% likely

Gold stays above US$4,500 into 2027, new Jubilee wells push the field above 90,000 barrels a day and the cocoa crop recovers. Reserves rise towards six months of imports, the cedi is broadly stable and the Bank of Ghana can cut rates further.

- Gold above US$4,500/oz through 2027
- Jubilee above 90,000 barrels a day from 2027
- Cocoa output recovers towards 750,000 tonnes
- Fiscal discipline holds through the 2028 election year

DOWNSIDE

25% likely

Gold falls back towards US$3,800, the cocoa crop disappoints and election-cycle spending returns. With large domestic bond repayments in 2027–2028, the cedi weakens faster, inflation moves above the target band and the Bank of Ghana has to raise rates again.

- Gold below US$3,800/oz by 2027
- Cocoa crop near or below 650,000 tonnes
- Energy-sector arrears rise again
- Fiscal slippage ahead of the 2028 general election

TABLE 1

Our forecasts at a glance

INDICATOR	2026	2027	2028
Real GDP growth (%)	**5.5** 5.0–6.0	**5.0** 3.5–6.0	**5.0** 3.5–6.0
Inflation, end of year (%)	**7.0** 6.0–9.0	**8.5** 7.0–13.0	**9.0** 7.5–14.0
Bank of Ghana policy rate, end of year (%)	**14.0** 13.0–14.0	**13.0** 11.0–17.0	**13.0** 10.5–18.0
Cedi per US dollar, end of year (GHS)	**12.2** 11.8–12.8	**13.4** 12.5–15.5	**14.8** 13.5–18.0
Gross reserves, months of imports (months)	**4.5** 4.0–4.8	**4.8** 3.5–5.5	**5.0** 3.0–6.0

Bold: base case. Small: range from downside to upside scenario.

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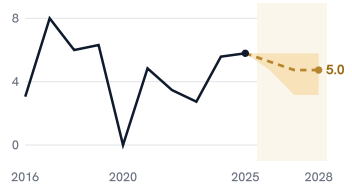
History and outlook

Actual Base case Upside–downside range

FIGURE 4

Real GDP growth

% · latest: H1 2026: 6.2%



H1 2026 grew 6.2%; we expect a slower second half as the oil boost fades. Official forecasts (4.8% for 2026) look cautious; Fitch Solutions expects 5.7%.

Official forecasts we start from

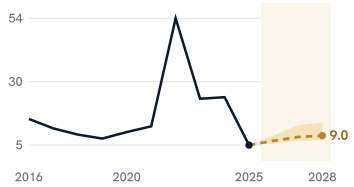
- IMF: 4.8 / 4.9 / 5.0% (2026/27/28) source
- World Bank: 4.8 / 4.9 / 5.0% source
- Ministry of Finance: at least 4.8% in 2026 source
- Fitch Solutions: 5.7% in 2026 source

History: IMF World Economic Outlook (Ghana Statistical Service data)

FIGURE 5

Inflation, end of year

% · latest: September 2026: 5.2%



Inflation (5.2% in September) is below the 8% ± 2 target band. The Bank of Ghana expects it to move up into the band over the next few quarters as higher utility tariffs and fuel prices pass through; Fitch Solutions expects a weaker cedi to push it to 9% by end-2026.

Official forecasts we start from

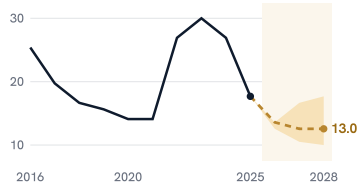
- IMF: 8.0% at end of each year source
- Bank of Ghana target: 8% ± 2 source
- Budget target: 8.0% at end-2026 source
- Fitch Solutions: 9.0% end-2026, 13.2% end-2027 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data

FIGURE 6

Bank of Ghana policy rate, end of year

% · latest: Since March 2026: 14.0%



With inflation near 5% the real policy rate is about 9%, very high; but rising inflation and a weaker cedi argue for holding in November and cutting slowly.

Official forecasts we start from

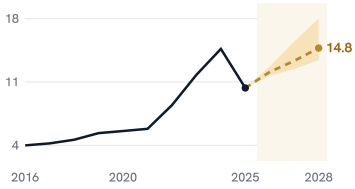
- Bank of Ghana: held at 14.0% on 24 September 2026 source
- Bank of Ghana: next decision 16–18 November 2026 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Monetary Policy Rate history

FIGURE 7

Cedi per US dollar, end of year

GHS · latest: September 2026: 11.55



The cedi has lost 9.5% this year after a 40.7% gain in 2025. Our base case assumes about 10% a year of depreciation from 2027, more in the 2028 election year.

Official forecasts we start from

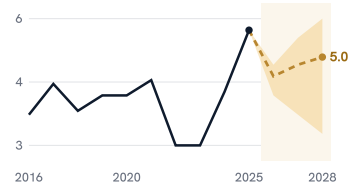
- Databank: GH¢12.20 at end-2026 source
- Bank of Ghana data: down 9.5% in January–September 2026 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data

FIGURE 8

Gross reserves, months of imports

months · latest: 22 September 2026: 4.5



Reserves fell from US$14.2bn in March to US$11.1bn in August; a lower gold price would slow the rebuild the IMF expects.

Official forecasts we start from

- IMF: 4.5 / 5.0 / 5.5 months of prospective imports (IMF basis; not comparable with BoG import cover) source
- Bank of Ghana: US$12.0bn, 4.5 months on 22 September 2026 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data

TABLE 2

What it means by sector

SECTOR	BASE CASE	UPSIDE	DOWNSIDE
Gold and mining	Margins stay strong even with the sliding royalty; watch the Minerals and Mining Act amendments on stability agreements.	Record export earnings; strongest case for new large-scale projects and local refining.	A lower gold price and the higher royalty bands squeeze new projects; small-scale output falls first.
Oil, gas and power	New Jubilee wells support output; power offtaker arrears remain the key risk for IPPs.	Output back above 100,000 barrels a day; more room to clear energy arrears.	Arrears build up again; prefer commercial and industrial solar with private offtakers.
Cocoa and agribusiness	Lower world cocoa prices cut export earnings; the 50% local-processing mandate supports grinders.	Crop recovery plus processing incentives make 2027 a good entry point for processors.	A small crop and EU deforestation rules hit volumes; traceability becomes a must-have.
ICT and fintech	Still the fastest-growing sector; a weaker cedi raises the cost of imported equipment.	Strong demand for payments, data centres and software services.	Growth slows but stays positive; cedi revenue loses value in dollars.
Real estate and construction	High interest rates keep mortgages scarce; demand for mid-market housing remains.	Rate cuts open up mortgage finance and construction activity.	Higher rates and a weaker cedi raise building costs and stall projects.
Exporters and importers	A gradually weaker cedi favours exporters with costs in cedis.	A stable cedi helps importers and companies with dollar debt.	Dollar earners win; importers and dollar borrowers should hedge.

Events that could move the forecast

16–18 Nov 2026
Bank of Ghana policy-rate decision

Early Nov 2026
2027 Budget Statement

Feb 2027
GH¢30bn of restructured domestic bonds fall due

Oct 2026 – Jan 2027
First IMF review under the Policy Coordination Instrument (mission October; Board completion expected by January 2027)

2027–2028
Domestic bond repayments of GH¢58bn and GH¢53bn

7 Dec 2028
General election (could move to early November 2028 if a proposed constitutional amendment is passed)

TABLE 3

Scorecard

We publish how our base-case forecasts compare with the outcomes, every quarter.

2026 FORECAST	BASE CASE	OUTCOME
Real GDP growth	5.5 %	*Due December 2026*
Inflation, end of year	7.0 %	*Due January 2027*
Bank of Ghana policy rate, end of year	14.0 %	*Due January 2027*
Cedi per US dollar, end of year	12.2 GHS	*Due January 2027*
Gross reserves, months of imports	4.5 months	*Due January 2027*

Scenarios start from the latest official projections and add our judgement on the drivers listed. They are estimates from public data, not a statistical model, and not investment advice. We review them every quarter and after major data releases, and keep a public scorecard of our forecasts against the outcomes.

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CHAPTER 1

Economy and investment climate

Ghana's real GDP grew 6.0% in Q2 2026 (6.2% in H1) with inflation at 5.2% in September and the Bank of Ghana policy rate held at 14.0%, as the country exited its US$3bn IMF programme in July 2026.

Ghana has moved from crisis recovery to post-programme consolidation: the IMF Board completed the final ECF review on 27 July 2026 and also reviewed a 36-month non-financing Policy Coordination Instrument (PCI) requested by the authorities. Growth remains solid (6.0% in Q2 2026, led by services and ICT at +30.9%), inflation is low at 5.2% (September 2026), public debt is 45.9% of GDP and gross reserves stood at US$12.0bn (4.5 months of imports) on 22 September 2026. The main macro watch-points are a cedi that has weakened 9.5% year-to-date to GHS 11.55/USD by 18 September 2026, a slower IMF growth projection of 4.9% for 2026, ratings still in single-B territory, and February 2027 domestic debt repayments. For investors, the new GIPA Act 2026 (Act 1173) removes blanket minimum capital for wholly foreign-owned firms and joint ventures, and press reports expect the 2027 Budget in the first week of November 2026.

Key figures

Real GDP growth

6.0 % y/y

Q2 2026 (H1 2026: 6.2%)

Reported MyJoyOnline reporting Ghana Statistical Service Q2 2026 GDP release (10 Sep 2026)

Nominal GDP

114.71 US$ billion

The IMF projects US$118.29bn for 2026.

2025 (IMF estimate)

Official IMF World Economic Outlook database (DataMapper, GDP in current US dollars)

Headline CPI inflation

5.2 % y/y

August 2026: 5.0%. Released by the Ghana Statistical Service on 7 October 2026.

September 2026

Reported GBC, "Inflation rises to 5.2% in September – GSS" (7 Oct 2026)

Bank of Ghana Monetary Policy Rate

14.0 %

Held at 132nd MPC, 23–24 Sep 2026

Official Bank of Ghana MPC Press Release, September 2026

Cedi exchange rate (interbank)

11.55 GHS per USD

9.5% depreciation year-to-date. August 2026: 11.25; December 2025: 10.45; about 11.76 on 6 October 2026 (GIPA indicators).

18 September 2026

Official Bank of Ghana Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

Gross international reserves

12.0 US$ billion

4.5 months of import cover.

22 September 2026

Official Bank of Ghana MPC Press Release, September 2026

Public debt

45.9 % of GDP

End-July 2026 (end-2025: 44.7%)

Official Bank of Ghana MPC Press Release, September 2026

Gold export receipts

14.86 US$ billion

Cocoa: US$2.76bn; crude oil: US$2.42bn.

January–August 2026 cumulative

Official Bank of Ghana Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

FDI inflows (registered projects: GIPA, Petroleum Commission, Free Zones Authority)

2.62 US$ billion

245 projects. 2024: US$651.7m. On a balance-of-payments basis the Bank of Ghana records US$1.91bn for 2025.

2025

Reported MyJoyOnline, reporting the GIPA 2025 Investment Report (21 Aug 2026)

Fitch sovereign rating

B

upgraded from B-, outlook positive

8 May 2026

Reported News Ghana reporting Fitch Ratings action

S&P sovereign rating

B-/B

affirmed, outlook stable

September 2026 (reported 28 Sep 2026; previously affirmed 27 Mar 2026)

Reported Modern Ghana reporting S&P Global Ratings action

Moody's sovereign rating

Caa1

affirmed, outlook raised to positive

April 2026

Reported Citi Newsroom reporting Moody's Ratings action

Rules that matter

- GIPA Act 2026 (Act 1173), assented 15 July 2026, converts GIPC into the Ghana Investment Promotion Authority, removes blanket minimum capital requirements for wholly foreign-owned enterprises and joint ventures, introduces a statutory Investor Grievance Mechanism, a One-Stop-Shop and annual registration renewal. source
- Trading enterprises with non-citizen participation still require a minimum of US$500,000 in cash equity (down from US$1m under Act 865), and at least 75% of the workforce must be skilled Ghanaians; the list of activities reserved for Ghanaians is retained but cut from eight to six (sources: GIPA via MyJoyOnline; Legal Ink/Clyde & Co). source · source 2
- Profit repatriation: Act 1173 protects the free transfer of capital, profits and dividends and retains protection against unlawful expropriation (law-firm summary; check the Act text before relying on specific clauses). source
- Free zones: a 10-year corporate income tax holiday (the rate after the holiday has changed over time; confirm it with GFZA and GRA); no withholding tax on dividends; duty-free imports for production; at least 70% of output must be exported (up to 30% may be sold locally); no restrictions on repatriation of dividends or net profit. source
- VAT reform under the VAT Act, 2025 (Act 1151), effective 1 January 2026: effective VAT rate 20% (15% VAT + 2.5% NHIL + 2.5% GETFund, with NHIL/GETFund now creditable as input tax), registration threshold for goods traders raised from GH₵200,000 to GH₵750,000, VAT Flat Rate Scheme and COVID-19 Health Recovery Levy abolished. source · source 2

Opportunities

- Digital economy momentum: ICT led services growth in Q2 2026 at +30.9% y/y and contributed 41.5% of total GDP growth, while investment rose 53.0%, supporting demand for data, connectivity and software services. source
- Cheaper local credit: the average lending rate fell to 15.9% from 24.2% a year earlier, the 91-day T-bill to 5.4%, and private-sector credit growth rebounded to 35.5% in August 2026. source
- 24-Hour Economy programme: the 24-Hour Economy Authority Act was assented in February 2026; announced incentives include 25% (two shifts) and 50% (three shifts) corporate tax rebates across eight sub-programmes (Grow24, Make24, Build24, Show24, Connect24, Fund24, Aspire24, Go24), though detailed incentive packages were still to be published as of August 2026. source
- Lower entry barriers under Act 1173: no general minimum capital for foreign-owned firms and JVs outside trading, plus a statutory grievance mechanism and GIPA 24-hour service for registrations, renewals and quota applications. source
- Public infrastructure pipeline: under the 'Big Push', 87 projects had commenced by mid-2026 and US$1.7bn was deposited in a dedicated account for the Accra–Kumasi expressway, creating supply-chain and contracting opportunities. source

Risks to price in

- Currency risk has returned: after strong appreciation in 2025, the cedi weakened 9.5% year-to-date to GHS 11.55/USD by 18 September 2026 (about GHS 11.76 by 6 October), and gross reserves fell from US$14.16bn (March 2026) to US$11.07bn (August 2026) before recovering to US$12.05bn on 22 September. source
- Growth expected to slow: the IMF projects real GDP growth of 4.9% for 2026, below the 6%+ prints of H1 2026; the government's 2026 budget target, unchanged at the mid-year review, is 4.8%. source · source 2
- Banking vulnerabilities persist in some state-owned banks, some private banks and specialised deposit-taking institutions (IMF). source
- Debt-service and refinancing: S&P kept Ghana at B-/B (Sept 2026), noting stronger reserves and exports have not removed constraints from high debt-service costs; the 2026 Mid-Year Budget Review targets a GHS30bn sinking fund by end-2026 to repay DDEP bonds falling due in February 2027. source · source 2
- Export concentration and price inflation drift: gold accounted for US$14.86bn of US$22.44bn total exports (about 66%) in Jan–Aug 2026, and headline inflation has risen for two months, from 4.6% (July) to 5.0% (August) and 5.2% (September 2026). source · source 2

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- 24-Hour Economy incentives are still being designed: the Presidential Advisor said (Aug 2026) that packages will be performance-based (tied to jobs, investment and productivity), carry sunset clauses of typically four to five years, and that beneficiaries will be listed on a public register; details are due 'in the coming months'. Separately, existing investment law already lets investors above US$50m negotiate tailored incentive packages under specific conditions. source

Who is who in this sector (6)

Bank of Ghana (BoG) Central bank; sets the Monetary Policy Rate (14.0%, held 24 Sep 2026; next decision 18 Nov 2026), manages reserves and foreign-exchange regulation; publishes the Summary of Economic and Financial Data (monthly series, released around each MPC meeting). source

Ghana Statistical Service (GSS) Publishes quarterly GDP and monthly CPI; September 2026 CPI (5.2%) was released on 7 October 2026; Q3 2026 GDP is due later in the year per the release calendar. source

Ghana Free Zones Authority (GFZA) Licenses export-oriented free zone enterprises and administers free zone tax and duty incentives. source

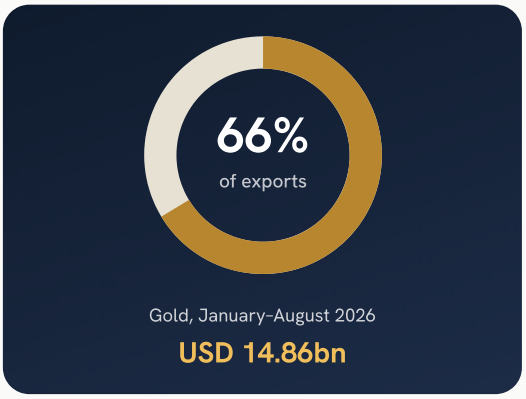
Ministry of Finance (MoF) Prepares the annual budget and mid-year review; the 2027 Budget is likely to be presented in the first week of November 2026 (press reports, not yet officially dated); manages the IMF PCI relationship. source · source 2

Ghana Investment Promotion Authority (GIPA, formerly GIPC) Registers foreign-participation enterprises, administers Act 1173, the One-Stop-Shop and the Investor Grievance Mechanism. source

International Monetary Fund (IMF) Completed Ghana's US$3bn ECF on 27 July 2026 with a final SDR 265.9m (~US$371m) disbursement; reviewed a 36-month non-financing Policy Coordination Instrument. source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data (listing page), GSS – Inflation rate highlight, GSS – Release calendar, Ministry of Finance – Press releases, GIPA – News articles, IMF – Ghana country page.

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CHAPTER 2

Gold, mining and critical minerals

Gold drives two-thirds of Ghana's exports as the state resets royalties, ASM trading and licensing rules

Gold exports reached USD 14.86bn in January–August 2026 out of USD 22.44bn in total exports (Bank of Ghana), after a record USD 20.98bn in 2025. Output reached 5.94 million ounces in 2025 (up 23.4%, Ghana Chamber of Mines), with artisanal and small-scale mining (3.11 Moz) overtaking large-scale mines (2.83 Moz), and the Ghana Gold Board (GoldBod) is now the sole buyer and exporter of ASM gold. Since 10 March 2026 a sliding-scale gold royalty of 5% to 12% applies under L.I. 2517, partly offset by a cut in the Growth and Sustainability Levy from 3% to 1% of gross production. Ghana ratified its first lithium mining lease (Ewoyaa) in March 2026, and a draft Minerals and Mining Bill, 2026, which would replace the 2006 Act, shorten mining leases and give the state a special share, is awaiting Parliament, which makes regulatory change the main thing for investors to watch.

Key figures

Gold exports, cumulative
14,863.2 USD million
Jan–Aug 2026
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026 (released 23 Sep 2026)

Total merchandise exports, cumulative
22,440.1 USD million
Jan–Aug 2026
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

Gold exports, full year
20,975.3 USD million
Jan–Dec 2025
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026 (2025:12 column)

International gold price, monthly average
4,408.4 USD per fine ounce
Bank of Ghana, from Reuters data.
August 2026
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

Total gold production
5.94 million ounces
2025
Reported Ghana Chamber of Mines 2025 industry data (annual report, June 2026), reported by Citi Newsroom (17 Aug 2026)

Large-scale mine gold production
2.83 million ounces
2025
Reported Ghana Chamber of Mines 2025 industry data, reported by Citi Newsroom (17 Aug 2026)

Artisanal and small-scale (ASM) gold production
3.11 million ounces
2025
Reported Ghana Chamber of Mines 2025 industry data, reported by Citi Newsroom (17 Aug 2026)

GoldBod ASM gold exported
104 metric tonnes
Generating over US$10bn.
Jan–Dec 2025
Reported Deputy Minister for Finance to Parliament (24 Jun 2026), reported by MyJoyOnline

GoldBod gold purchase spending
16.1 USD billion
Of which US$9.8bn in 2025.
Jan 2025–May 2026
Reported Deputy Minister for Finance to Parliament (24 Jun 2026), reported by MyJoyOnline

GoldBod gold purchases from small-scale miners, year-to-date
69–70 metric tonnes
About US$9.4bn. Spoken estimate by the GoldBod CEO, not audited data.
2026, to early August
Reported GoldBod CEO, interview reported by MyJoyOnline (10 Aug 2026)

Newmont Ahafo North expected output
275,000–325,000 ounces per year
Next five years from commercial production (announced 24 Oct 2025); 13-year mine life
Reported Newmont news release (24 Oct 2025)

Forest reserve area degraded by illegal mining
8,923.8 hectares
45 forest reserves and a national park.
As at 31 Dec 2024 (released 24 Feb 2026)
Reported Forestry Commission remote-sensing study, reported by Graphic Online

Rules that matter

- Royalties: the Minerals and Mining (Royalties) Regulations, 2025 (L.I. 2517), in force since 10 March 2026, replace the flat 5% gold royalty with a price-linked scale. The rate is 5% up to US$1,900/oz and 6% from US$1,900 to US$2,000, then rises one point per US$500/oz band to 12% above US$4,500/oz. The gold price is the weekly average of the LBMA London PM price for the month's sales. Small-scale gold pays 2%, and lithium (spodumene) has its own 5%–12% scale. Diamonds, bauxite, manganese, iron ore and industrial minerals stay at 5%. At the Bank of Ghana's August 2026 average gold price of US$4,408.4/oz, the 11% band (above US$4,000 to US$4,500) would apply. source
- Growth and Sustainability Levy: in March 2026 Parliament passed an amendment cutting the levy on mining companies' gross production from 3% to 1%, to offset the new sliding-scale royalties. source
- Mineral rights (Minerals and Mining Act, 2006, Act 703) are granted by the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources on the recommendation of the Minerals Commission. The reconnaissance licence runs 12 months (up to 5,000 blocks of 21 ha). The prospecting licence runs 3 years (up to 750 blocks). The mining lease runs up to 30 years (up to 300 blocks) and the restricted mining lease up to 15 years for building and industrial minerals. The small-scale mining licence lasts 5 years and is reserved for Ghanaians only. The Government holds a 10% free carried interest in mining operations. source · source 2
- Gold trading: under the Ghana Gold Board Act, 2025 (Act 1140), GoldBod has the exclusive right to buy, sell, assay, value and export ASM gold. Foreign nationals had to leave local gold trading by 30 April 2025, and dealing in gold without a GoldBod licence has been an offence since 1 May 2025. Licences held by large-scale mining companies were not revoked under this reset. From 1 September 2026, Self-Financing Aggregators must refine gold doré at a GoldBod-approved refinery in Ghana before export. source · source 2
- Forest reserves: the Environmental Protection (Mining in Forest Reserves) Revocation Instrument, 2025 matured into law on 10 December 2025. It revokes L.I. 2462, which had allowed the President to authorise mining in forest reserves. source

Opportunities

- Large-scale exploration and mining rights are open to foreign-owned Ghanaian companies through the Minerals Commission's licensing process (reconnaissance, prospecting and mining lease), using the online mining cadastre. Small-scale licences remain reserved for Ghanaians. source
- Lithium: in March 2026 Parliament ratified Atlantic Lithium's Ewoyaa mining lease (announced 20 March 2026), the first lithium lease granted and ratified in Ghana (initial 15-year term, sliding royalty of 5% to 12%). The project is moving towards a final investment decision, creating openings for offtake, financing, EPC and services. source
- Refining and value addition: GoldBod's mandatory local refining of aggregator doré from 1 September 2026 creates demand for GoldBod-approved refining, assaying and logistics capacity in Ghana. source
- Bauxite and aluminium: GIADEC is seeking partners to build an integrated bauxite–alumina–aluminium value chain on an estimated 920 million tonnes of bauxite (Awaso, Nyinahin, Kyebi). It offers resource-for-credit swaps, long-term offtake and joint-venture partnerships (as at June 2025). source
- Mining services and supply chain: new large-scale capacity such as Newmont's Ahafo North (commercial production from October 2025, about 560 permanent and 1,000 contracted operating roles) needs contractors and suppliers. Foreign providers typically take part through partnerships that comply with the L.I. 2431 local content rules. source

Risks to price in

- Fiscal take: the L.I. 2517 royalty reaches 12% above US$4,500/oz. The Ghana Chamber of Mines warned that the increase would hit new projects immediately and put the projected 6.5 Moz output for 2026 at risk. source
- Legal reform: in July 2026 Cabinet approved a revised mining law for Parliament. A draft Minerals and Mining Bill, 2026 would replace the 2006 Act. It would replace reconnaissance and prospecting licences with a single exploration licence capped at five years, cut mining lease terms to 15 years (or the life of the mine, if shorter), give the state a special share, and require community development agreements negotiated with host communities. The government has also signalled plans to phase out fiscal stability agreements. The bill had not been debated as of end-September 2026 and could be taken up when Parliament resumes in October. source · source 2
- Lease renewal risk: the Damang mining lease was not renewed for Gold Fields beyond a one-year extension to 18 April 2026. After a tender, the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources granted the lease to Engineers and Planners, which took over the mine on 18–19 April 2026. Gold Fields' main Tarkwa leases are due to expire in April 2027 (renewal applied for). source
- ESG and illegal mining (galamsey): the Forestry Commission recorded 8,923.8 ha of forest reserves degraded by illegal mining as at end-2024. In February 2026 the government announced a Ghana Armed Forces-led cleanup of water bodies and stronger NAIMOS enforcement. Investors face reputational, community and supply-chain due-diligence exposure. source
- Concentration and price exposure: gold makes up about two-thirds of export earnings and ASM supplies more than half of output. GoldBod based its 2026 forecasts on about US$5,000/oz, above recent prices, so export receipts and state gold purchases are sensitive to the gold price. source

- Local content and fiscal terms: the Minerals and Mining (Local Content and Local Participation) Regulations, 2020 (L.I. 2431) set local procurement, employment and participation requirements. Corporate income tax on mineral operations is 35%. Under current law, stability agreements can run up to 15 years, and development agreements are available for investments above US$500m. source

Who is who in this sector (8)

Minerals Commission Main regulator for mineral rights. Receives and evaluates licence applications, runs the mining cadastre, inspects mines and makes recommendations to the Minister of Lands and Natural Resources. source

Newmont Operates Ahafo South and Ahafo North (commercial production October 2025; 275,000–325,000 oz/yr guided over the next five years). source

AngloGold Ashanti Owns 100% of the Obuasi underground mine (Ashanti Region; 266,000 oz in FY25) and also operates Iduapriem. source

Asante Gold Listed on TSXV and GSE; operates the Bibiani and Chirano gold mines. 2026 guidance is 275,000–300,000 oz at an AISC of US$3,200–3,600/oz. source

Ghana Gold Board (GoldBod) Set up under Act 1140 (2025) as the sole authority to buy, sell, assay, value and export ASM gold and other precious minerals. Licenses gold traders and aggregators and sets refining rules. source

Gold Fields Holds 90% of the Tarkwa mine, with the Government of Ghana holding 10%. Attributable Mineral Reserves are about 6.6 Moz (31 Dec 2025) and the CIL plant has 14.7 Mtpa capacity. The main Tarkwa leases expire in April 2027 (renewal applied for). Gold Fields exited Damang in April 2026. source

Zijin Mining Completed its US$1bn acquisition of the Akyem open-pit gold mine from Newmont on 16 April 2025. source

Atlantic Lithium Developer of the Ewoyaa lithium project (Central Region), holder of Ghana's first ratified lithium mining lease (ratified March 2026). source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data, GoldBod news, Minerals Commission – News & Events, Ghana Chamber of Mines – News updates, Newmont – Operations (Ahafo South/North).

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CHAPTER 3

Oil and gas, power and renewables

Jubilee drilling reverses a six-year oil decline while power-sector finances improve but remain the main investor risk

Ghana's crude output fell for a sixth consecutive year in 2025 to 37.3 million barrels, but a 2026 Jubilee infill campaign lifted oil and gas activity by 22.4% in Q2 2026, and oil exports reached US$2.42bn in January–August 2026. Jubilee and TEN licences have been extended to 2040, which brings up to 20 additional Jubilee wells; a further 10-well campaign is signed for 2027–28. The power system has 5,818 MW installed and depends on thermal plants for about three-quarters of generation. The IMF reports the energy-sector shortfall fell to US$1.4bn in 2025, but legacy payables to IPPs and fuel suppliers were still US$1.7bn in March 2026, so offtaker credit risk remains the central issue for power investors.

Key figures

Crude oil export earnings (year to date)

2,424.9 USD million

January–August 2026 (cumulative)

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

Oil and gas sector real growth

22.4 % year on year

Some outlets reported 21.4%; the Ghana News Agency and Ghana Business News report 22.4%.

Q2 2026

Reported Ghana Statistical Service Q2 2026 GDP release, reported by the Ghana News Agency (9 Sep 2026)

Total crude oil production (Jubilee, TEN, Sankofa-Gye Nyame)

37.3 million barrels

37,302,798 barrels.

Calendar year 2025

Official PIAC 2025 Annual Report

Total petroleum receipts to the state

770.27 USD million

Calendar year 2025 (down 43.27% from US$1.36bn in 2024)

Official PIAC 2025 Annual Report

Jubilee field gross oil production

72,000 barrels per day

Approximate.

Q2 2026 average

Reported Kosmos Energy, Second Quarter 2026 Results (3 Aug 2026)

TEN fields gross oil production

14,700 barrels per day

Approximate.

Q2 2026 average

Reported Kosmos Energy, Second Quarter 2026 Results (3 Aug 2026)

Installed grid generation capacity (dependable: 4,968 MW)

5,818 MW

July 2026

Reported PURC Ghana Electricity Supply Fact Sheet, July 2026, reported by MyJoyOnline

Thermal share of electricity generation

74.33 % of total generation

July 2026

Reported PURC Ghana Electricity Supply Fact Sheet, July 2026, reported by MyJoyOnline

Energy-sector financial shortfall (revenue vs cost gap)

1.4 USD billion

1.2% of GDP.

2025 (from US$1.6bn in 2024)

Official IMF Country Report No. 26/212, Ghana Sixth ECF Review / 2026 Article IV

Net payables owed to IPPs and fuel suppliers

1.7 USD billion

End-March 2026 (from US$2.1bn at end-2024)

Reported IMF assessment reported by Ghana News Agency (Aug 2026)

Electricity tariff adjustment (quarterly mechanism)

0 % tariff change

Q3 2026: +3.49%.

Q4 2026 (1 Oct–31 Dec)

Official IMF Country Report No. 26/212 (Q3); PURC Q4 decision reported by GNA (24 Sep 2026)

Share of upstream service contract value awarded to indigenous Ghanaian companies

29 %

US$324.1m.

Calendar year 2025

Official PIAC 2025 Annual Report

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Rules that matter

- Local content (L.I. 2204, 2013): an indigenous Ghanaian company other than GNPC must hold at least 5% equity for a party to qualify for a petroleum agreement or licence; a foreign company supplying goods or services to the upstream sector must form a joint venture giving an indigenous Ghanaian company at least 10% equity. Operators must also run bidding processes that give preference to indigenous companies. source
- Renewable Energy Act, 2011 (Act 832), s.8: any commercial activity in the renewable energy industry needs an Energy Commission licence. This covers production, transport, storage, distribution, sale, import, export and installation/maintenance. source
- Act 832 as amended by Act 1045 (2020), s.25: renewable electricity bought by public utilities and wholesale suppliers must go through a competitive procurement scheme (tender or auction). Public utilities may not negotiate PPAs for renewable power unless it has gone through an open, competitive and transparent procurement process. source
- Net metering (Act 832 s.30A, inserted 2020): a statutory net-metering scheme for renewable self-generation. Under s.26, distribution utilities must procure renewable electricity from consumer-generators. source
- PURC resets electricity and water tariffs every quarter. It indexes them to the cedi–dollar rate, inflation, the weighted average cost of gas (US$7.8379/MMBtu used for Q4 2026, down from US$7.9708 in Q3) and the hydro–thermal generation mix. For Q4 2026 (1 Oct–31 Dec) the change is 0%. source
- Energy Commission standards and labelling regulations (in force since November 2022; enforced from November 2023 after a one-year transition) cover solar panels (L.I. 2449), renewable-energy batteries (L.I. 2452) and inverters (L.I. 2461). Importers must register products with the Energy Commission (accredited test reports) and meet labelling requirements. source

Opportunities

- Upstream services and drilling supply chain. Tullow's 2025–26 Jubilee campaign was completed in September 2026, with six producers and one water injector onstream. A rig contract for a 2027–28 campaign of up to 10 wells is signed, with the rig expected around mid-2027. The Jubilee and TEN licence extensions to 2040 (ratified February 2026) allow up to 20 additional Jubilee wells. Service firms must meet the 10% indigenous joint-venture rule. source
- Gas supply and processing. GRIDCo's 2025 Electricity Supply Plan put firm Jubilee/TEN/OCTP supply at about 416 mmscf/d. It also identified a need for additional gas volumes to meet thermal demand. Eni says OCTP meets about 70% of gas demand for power generation, and Eban-Akoma (declared commercial July 2025) is set to become a new source of supply. source
- Utility-scale solar plus storage for industry. Up to 1.5 GW of solar with battery storage is being developed at Buipe under the government's 24-Hour Economy (24H+) Programme. The joint development agreement was signed on 10 April 2026, and in July 2026 the presidential adviser said construction of the first 100 MW would begin in August 2026. The target is to cut industrial power costs from 18–23 to 7–9 US cents/kWh. source
- Commercial and industrial (C&I) and rooftop solar under net metering. Grid supply is about 74% thermal, and the law provides a net-metering scheme and a renewable purchase obligation on distribution utilities. Together these support behind-the-meter solar for factories, mines and commercial property. source
- Distribution private-sector participation. The IMF reports that a transaction adviser has been appointed to procure ECG concessionaires, with concessions expected to be awarded by June 2027. This is an entry point for distribution operators, metering and loss-reduction contractors. source

Risks to price in

- Offtaker payment risk. Net payables to IPPs and fuel suppliers were still US$1.7bn at end-March 2026. The IMF projects a sector shortfall of about US$1.1bn in 2026, driven by collection and distribution losses, and warns the sector is prone to slippages during electoral periods. source
- Mature-field production decline. Ghana's crude output fell for the sixth consecutive year in 2025, down 22.7% to 37.3m barrels. New Jubilee wells lifted output in 2026 (about 72,000 bopd gross in Q2; GNPC cites more than 80,000 bopd in September), but sustaining it depends on continued infill drilling in mature fields. source
- Fiscal and tax disputes. On 30 September 2026 an ICC tribunal found that a US$196.5m corporate income tax assessment on Tullow was not in breach of its petroleum agreements. Investors should model the risk of tax claims under stability clauses. source
- Currency and tariff risk. Revenue is in cedis while gas and many IPP contracts are priced in dollars. PURC tariffs move quarterly with FX and gas costs (Q2 2026: -4.81%; Q3: +3.49%; Q4: 0%), so cedi depreciation or a tariff freeze compresses cost recovery. source
- Thermal and gas dependence. Thermal plants supplied 74.33% of generation in July 2026, and PURC's Q4 2026 tariff assumed a mix that is 75.75% thermal (79.10% in Q3). Supply depends on domestic gas availability and pricing, which exposes generators and offtakers to field outages and gas cost changes. source

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Who is who in this sector (8)

Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) National oil company and carried-interest partner in all fields. Reports Jubilee above 80,000 bopd (Sept 2026) and about US$3.5bn of partner upstream investment commitments. source

Petroleum Commission Upstream regulator responsible for licensing, permits and local content (L.I. 2204). Promoting new investment, including the South Deep Water Tano negotiations. source

Tullow Oil Operator of Jubilee and TEN. Working-interest output was 43.7 kboepd in H1 2026, and it has recovered its historic Ghana gas receivables. source

Kosmos Energy Jubilee and TEN partner. Its licences were extended to 2040 (ratified February 2026), with up to US$2bn of incremental investment. source

Eni (OCTP / Sankofa-Gye Nyame, with Vitol and GNPC) Operator of OCTP, which supplies about 70% of Ghana's gas demand for power generation. Developing the Eban-Akoma discovery. source

Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC) Sets electricity and water tariffs through quarterly adjustments and publishes monthly electricity supply fact sheets. source

Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG) Main distribution utility and power offtaker, and the main source of sector losses. Concessions for private participation are expected to be awarded by June 2027. source

Energy Commission Licenses renewable-energy and electricity businesses, enforces equipment standards, and led stakeholder validation of the 2026 Integrated Power System Master Plan (September 2026). source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data, PURC – tariff announcements and electricity supply fact sheets, Petroleum Commission newsroom, PIAC reports, Tullow Oil press releases, Kosmos Energy investor news.

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CHAPTER 4

Cocoa, agribusiness and agro-processing

Cocoa earnings rise and financing is moving onshore, as a 50% local-processing mandate begins with the 2026/27 season

Bank of Ghana data show cocoa exports of USD 2.76bn for January–August 2026, up from USD 2.47bn a year earlier, although gold still accounts for most export earnings. COCOBOD has replaced its decades-old offshore syndicated loan with a GH¢16.3bn domestic notes programme run by its subsidiary Cocoa Capital PLC, and opened the 2026/27 season at GH¢42,400 per tonne (about 27% below the 2025/26 opening price) (71.18% of realised gross FOB, above the 70% floor in the new Ghana Cocoa Board Act, 2026). From 2026/27, Cabinet policy requires at least half of the cocoa crop to be processed locally, while the 13 existing grinders run at only 30–40% of about 500,000 tonnes of installed capacity. Beyond cocoa, the investment case rests on import substitution (2025 food imports were GH¢36.46bn), cashew and shea processing, and cold chain. Swollen shoot disease, illegal mining, smuggling, EUDR compliance from 30 December 2026 and cedi volatility are the main risks.

Key figures

Cocoa export earnings, cumulative

2,762.4 USD million

January–August 2025: US$2,467.3m.

Jan–Aug 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

Cocoa export earnings, first half

2,300.0 USD million

H1 2025: US$2,167.5m.

Jan–Jun 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

Cocoa export earnings, full year

4,000.8 USD million

Jan–Dec 2025

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

Cocoa producer price, 2026/27 season

42,400 GH¢ per tonne

GH¢2,650 per 64 kg bag; 71.18% of realised gross FOB. Up 2.4% on the February 2026 mid-season price of GH¢41,392, but about 27% below the 2025/26 opening price of GH¢58,000.

2026/27 season, from 25 Sep 2026

Official COCOBOD, Review of the producer price of cocoa for the 2026/27 season (25 Sep 2026)

Cocoa Capital PLC domestic financing programme (GH¢14bn commercial paper + GH¢2.3bn bonds)

16.3 GH¢ billion

2026/27 season (announced Sep 2026)

Reported Ghana News Agency

COCOBOD cocoa purchases (financial year, Oct–Sep)

597,377 tonnes

2024: 448,969 tonnes.

FY2025 (Oct 2024–Sep 2025)

Reported MyJoyOnline (31 Aug 2026), reporting SIGA 2025 State Ownership Report (COCOBOD management accounts)

COCOBOD net profit (2024: loss of GH¢5.73bn)

5.11 GH¢ billion

FY2025 (Oct 2024–Sep 2025; management accounts)

Reported MyJoyOnline (31 Aug 2026), reporting SIGA 2025 State Ownership Report (COCOBOD management accounts)

Agriculture real GDP growth, year on year (crops +5.2%, livestock +5.9%, fishing -24.7%)

3.9 %

Q2 2025: 7.1%.

Q2 2026

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting Ghana Statistical Service quarterly GDP

Combined installed cocoa processing capacity (13 companies, running at 30–40% utilisation)

500,000 tonnes per year

May 2026

Reported Graphic Online, reporting the Cocoa Marketing Company MD

Cashew export revenue (42% of USD 710.3m non-traditional agricultural exports; shea nuts USD 177.79m)

297.59 USD million

2025

Reported Ecofin Agency, citing Ghana Export Promotion Authority

Cocoa products (butter, cake) within non-traditional exports; total NTEs passed USD 5bn

>800 USD million

2025

Reported Ghana News Agency, citing Ghana Export Promotion Authority

Food import bill

36.46 GH¢ billion

Largest items: processed cereal grains, frozen chicken and animal offal (GH¢2.72bn); rice, including broken rice, about GH¢3.6bn.

2025

Reported Graphic Online, reporting GSS Annual International Merchandise Trade Statistics

Rules that matter

- The Ghana Cocoa Board Act, 2026 (Act 1182) requires farmers to receive at least 70% of the realised gross FOB price. Haulier, buying-margin, warehousing and inspection rates for 2026/27 are unchanged. source
- In February 2026 Cabinet approved a directive requiring at least 50% of Ghana's cocoa beans to be processed locally, starting with the 2026/27 crop season. source
- Non-citizens (including companies with more than 40% non-citizen ownership) may hold land only as leasehold, for no more than 50 years at any one time (Land Act 2020, Act 1036, s.10). Any grant of freehold to a non-citizen is void. A fixed-term lease to a non-Ghanaian is not renewable unless the lease expressly provides for renewal (s.50(17)), so renewal terms must be negotiated up front. Registered leases can be mortgaged. source
- Free zone enterprises pay no income tax for 10 years (confirm the rate that applies afterwards with GFZA and GRA, as it has changed). Imports for production are duty-free and dividends are exempt from withholding tax. At least 70% of output must be exported, so up to 30% may be sold locally. source
- Outside free zones, agro-processors that mainly use local raw materials get a 5-year concessionary period. GRA calls it a tax holiday, but its table shows a 5% special rate during it. After that, location-based rates apply: 5% in the Northern, Upper East and Upper West Regions, 10% outside regional capitals, 15% in other regional capitals and 20% in Accra/Tema. Tree-crop farming gets a 10-year concessionary period, and exporters of non-traditional products pay a concessionary 8% rate. GRA's guidance is internally inconsistent, so confirm current rates with GRA. source

Opportunities

- Cocoa grinding and semi-finished products. The 13 local processors run at only 30–40% of about 500,000 t of installed capacity, and the 50% local-processing mandate from 2026/27 is meant to direct more beans to local grinders. This creates openings for capacity revival, working-capital finance and offtake. source
- Domestic cocoa paper. Cocoa Capital PLC's GH¢16.3bn programme (GH¢14bn of commercial paper for 2026/27 purchases, GH¢2.3bn of bonds to refinance legacy debt) is repaid from assigned forward-sales receivables through ring-fenced accounts. The Finance Minister said the paper would be issued in three tranches over an 8-month season and would widen participation to pension funds and non-resident investors. The first 266-day tranche raised GH¢3.39bn against a GH¢4bn target at 11% (October 2026). source · source 2
- Import substitution in rice and poultry. GSS puts the 2025 food import bill at GH¢36.46bn. The Feed Ghana coordinator reports rice sufficiency up from 42% to 56% and poultry from 5% to 21%, which still leaves a large gap for integrated poultry, feed and rice-milling investment. source
- Cashew and shea processing. A Nitidae/ACPG study found Ghana processed only about 15,000 t of raw cashew in 2025, under 6% of estimated output of 262,000 t, while about 444,000 t of raw nuts (including informal imports from neighbours) were exported. In July 2025 the government announced a phased ban on raw shea-nut exports from 2026. GEPA reports shea-nut exports more than doubled to USD 177.79m in 2025, partly because exporters front-loaded shipments ahead of the ban. source · source 2

Risks to price in

- Cocoa swollen shoot virus disease. In February 2024 COCOBOD's then chief executive said more than 500,000 hectares of cocoa farms had been lost to it. This constrains bean supply for processors and the long-term outlook for output. source
- Illegal mining (galamsey) on farmland. A 2022 COCOBOD study reported more than 19,000 ha of surveyed cocoa farms destroyed or affected (some outlets reported acres). The damage was concentrated in the Eastern, Western and Ashanti regions, which produce over 90% of the crop. This covers selected farms, not a national total, and COCOBOD said in 2024 it had no up-to-date national data. source
- Smuggling. A COCOBOD official estimated losses of almost USD 1.1bn to cocoa smuggling into Togo and Côte d'Ivoire over 2022–2025. Recorded output in Volta/Oti collapsed from 7,215 t (2020/21) to 87 t (2024/25). source
- EU Deforestation Regulation compliance. EUDR applies to cocoa exports from 30 December 2026, so traceability and geolocation gaps could disrupt shipments to the EU. source
- FX and financing. The cedi depreciated 7.1% against the USD in the year to end-August 2026, and 9.5% by 18 September 2026 (BoG). Crop finance now depends on domestic money-market appetite for COCOBOD paper rather than offshore syndicated loans. source

- The Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Act, 2026 (Act 1173, assented 15 July 2026) replaces Act 865. It removes blanket minimum capital requirements for wholly foreign-owned enterprises and joint ventures, keeping thresholds only for trading. It also adds a one-stop shop and an investor grievance mechanism. source

- Cold chain and processed food for AfCFTA markets. The US International Trade Administration (2022) put the revenue potential of cold-chain solutions in Ghana's fruit and vegetable value chains at up to USD 900m a year. Government is repositioning special economic zones around agro-processing and offering rules-of-origin support for AfCFTA trade, with the AfCFTA Secretariat based in Accra. source

Who is who in this sector (8)

Ghana Cocoa Board (COCOBOD) State regulator and sole marketer of cocoa. It sets the producer price (GH¢42,400/t for 2026/27) and leads disease control and EUDR readiness. source

Cocoa Capital PLC Wholly owned COCOBOD subsidiary issuing the GH¢16.3bn Domestic Cocoa Notes Programme. Bookrunners are Absa, CalBank, Fincap, GCB, One Africa Securities and Stanbic. source

Cocoa Marketing Company (CMC) COCOBOD's marketing arm, which handles forward sales and is tasked with supporting greater use of local processing capacity. source

Cocoa Processing Company (CPC) Listed state-linked chocolate and semi-finished cocoa producer. It plans to more than double its chocolate output (currently 700–1,000 cartons a day) through new machinery and refurbishment. source

Ghana Export Promotion Authority (GEPA) Export promotion agency. It reports non-traditional exports above USD 5bn in 2025, targets USD 10bn by 2030 and runs the Accelerated Export Development Programme. source

Ghana Free Zones Authority (GFZA) Licenses export-oriented free zone enterprises, including agro-processors, under the 10-year tax holiday regime. source

Ghana Investment Promotion Authority (GIPA) Investment registration and promotion body under Act 1173 (2026). It runs the one-stop shop and the investor grievance mechanism. source

Feed Ghana Programme (Ministry of Food and Agriculture) Flagship food-security programme launched April 2025, covering the Nkoko Nkitinkiti poultry scheme, inputs and irrigation. Its second phase from October 2026 focuses on value-chain linkages. source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data, COCOBOD news, Ghana Statistical Service – release calendar, Ghana Free Zones Authority, Ghana News Agency.

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CHAPTER 5

ICT and fintech, manufacturing, real estate and logistics

ICT leads Ghana's growth and mobile money exceeds GH¢500bn a month, while ports run near capacity and industrial policy has moved from 1D1F to the 24-Hour Economy (24H+) framework

Ghana's Statistical Service reported ICT growth of 30.9% year-on-year in Q2 2026, the main driver of 6.0% real GDP growth, and Bank of Ghana data show monthly mobile money transactions of GH¢518.8bn in August 2026. The new Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Act, 2026 (Act 1173) removes blanket minimum capital for non-trading foreign enterprises, and the 24-Hour Economy Authority Act (assented February 2026) is the new channel for manufacturing incentives after the One District One Factory programme was discontinued in 2025. Housing remains structurally short (deficit estimated at over 1.8 million units), with non-citizens limited to leaseholds of up to 50 years, renewable only if the lease says so. Container traffic through Tema and Takoradi rose 12.2% in January–May 2026, but congestion at Tema and slow delivery of inland port and rail projects are binding constraints.

Key figures

ICT (information & communication) real growth

30.9 % y/y

Q2 2026

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting GSS Q2 2026 GDP release (9 Sep 2026)

Manufacturing sub-sector growth

6.6 % y/y

Q2 2026 (vs 5.4% Q2 2025)

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting GSS Q2 2026 GDP release

Construction growth

4.4 % y/y

Q2 2026 (vs 6.5% Q2 2025)

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting GSS Q2 2026 GDP release

Mobile money (e-money) transaction value (volume: 1,046 million transactions)

518.8 GH¢ billion per month

August 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Charts, September 2026

Active e-money customers (registered: 85.8 million)

26.4 million

August 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, FinTech Statistics

Mobile money transaction value, full year

4.54 GH¢ trillion

+50.8% y/y.

2025

Official Bank of Ghana, Payment Systems Oversight Annual Report 2025

Mobile voice subscriptions (penetration 129.55%)

44.15 million

June 2026

Official National Communications Authority, Monthly Industry Voice June 2026

Total data subscriptions (penetration 90.17%)

30.73 million

June 2026

Official National Communications Authority, Monthly Industry Data June 2026

Housing deficit

>1.8 million units

Estimate stated 28 Jan 2026

Reported 3News, quoting the Minister for Works and Housing

Container traffic, Tema and Takoradi (laden, inbound + outbound)

394,742 containers

+12.2% y/y.

January–May 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Monetary Policy Report July 2026

National container throughput (Tema 1,668,688 TEU; Takoradi 32,558 TEU)

1,701,246 TEU

Projected.

2024

Reported Citi Newsroom, reporting GPHA statistics (30 Sep 2025)

MPS Terminal 3 (Tema) annual handling capacity after equipment upgrade

2.5 → 3.0 million TEU

Announced March 2026

Reported Meridian Port Services

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Boankra inland port: construction progress against the April 2026 target

6 vs 20 % of the period target achieved

Not overall completion: phase one, due in Q1 2025, was reported more than 80% complete in April 2026. US$308m project.

April 2026

Reported News Ghana (24 Apr 2026)

Rules that matter

- Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Act, 2026 (Act 1173), assented 15 July 2026, repeals the GIPC Act 2013 (Act 865). Blanket minimum capital for wholly foreign-owned and joint-venture enterprises is removed; foreign trading enterprises need US$500,000 cash equity and at least 75% skilled Ghanaian staff; expatriate quota of 2–12 staff scales with invested capital (US$50,000 to >US$10m); GIPA registration must be renewed annually. source
- Bank of Ghana licenses non-bank payments under seven categories: Dedicated Electronic Money Issuer, PSP Scheme, PSP-Enhanced, PSP-Medium, PSP-Standard (reserved for Ghanaians and wholly Ghanaian-owned entities), Payment and Financial Technology Service Provider, and Digital Credit Services Provider. Applications go through the BoG FinTech & Innovation Office; a regulatory sandbox admitted six firms for one year in January 2026 to test virtual-asset products. source
- Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843): all data controllers and processors must register with the Data Protection Commission. source
- Free Zones Act, 1995 (Act 504): free-zone enterprises must export at least 70% of annual output (up to 30% may be sold locally) and may be 100% foreign-owned. GFZA lists a 10-year corporate income tax holiday, exemption from duties on imports for production, and exemption from dividend withholding tax. EY (Oct 2025) reports that the reduced post-holiday rate and dividend exemptions were repealed by later tax laws, so confirm the post-holiday rate and dividend treatment with GFZA and GRA before modelling. source
- Land Act, 2020 (Act 1036), s.10(6), and Article 266 of the Constitution: no leasehold exceeding 50 years at any one time may be granted to a non-citizen. The lease is renewable; freehold is not available to non-citizens. source

Opportunities

- Payments and embedded finance: mobile money reached GH¢518.8bn and 1.05bn transactions in August 2026, but only about 26.4m of 85.8m registered accounts are active. This leaves room for merchant acquiring, cross-border remittance and B2B payments (PSP-Enhanced licence), digital credit (Digital Credit Services Provider licence or bank partnership) and KYC, scoring and fraud tooling (PFTSP licence). source
- Fixed broadband and data infrastructure: mobile data penetration is 87.65%, but fibre broadband had only 273,095 subscriptions and Starlink 28,612 in Q1 2026. This points to underbuilt fixed, enterprise-connectivity and hosting capacity behind 30.9% ICT growth. source
- Tech talent and offshore delivery: the government's One Million Coders Programme, rolled out nationally in April 2026, targets 300,000 trainees in 2026 across 130 learning centres. It is a pipeline for software, AI and cybersecurity operations. source
- Export manufacturing and agro-processing: multi-shift plants can combine 24H+ CIT reductions, duty-free equipment and the G-LVAR rebate. Free-zone status (100% foreign ownership, 10-year tax holiday) and lower GIPA entry thresholds suit export-oriented, AfCFTA-facing production; 50 states had ratified AfCFTA by October 2025. source
- Housing and building materials: a deficit officially estimated at over 1.8 million units, urbanisation above 50% and stalled affordable-housing schemes create demand for mid-market housing delivery, rental platforms, construction finance and local materials. Non-citizens are limited to 50-year renewable leases. source

Risks to price in

- Port congestion: in September 2026 the Transport Minister ordered urgent action at Tema after container volumes 'increased almost to 100 per cent' and system outages at the MPS terminal. Expect demurrage, delays and off-dock diversion during peak season. source
- Infrastructure delivery: Boankra inland terminal construction achieved only 6% against a 20% milestone for April 2026, and phase one, due in Q1 2025, is still unfinished. The Tema–Mpakadan railway needed a US$21m EU grant (July 2026) to fix signalling and other systems that were incomplete at commissioning. Do not base logistics plans on rail or inland-port capacity yet. source
- Industrial policy discontinuity: the Trade Minister told Parliament on 8 July 2025 that 'there is no policy as 1D1F' and that no incentives currently applied under it, with the ministry still assessing the fallout for 1D1F companies. Incentives under the successor 24H+ programme depend on the new Authority and enabling tax measures. source
- Free-zone tax erosion: EY (Oct 2025) reports that Act 504's reduced post-holiday rate (8%) and dividend exemptions were repealed, with domestic sales taxed at the standard 25% CIT; the same note cites 15% on export profits after the holiday. GFZA still advertises a maximum of 8%. Confirm the applicable rate with GRA before modelling. source
- Telecom market concentration: MTN Ghana holds 80.10% of mobile data subscriptions and 72.5% of mobile voice subscriptions (June 2026). Pricing, interconnection and significant-market-power rules can change quickly for entrants and partners. source · source 2
- Regulatory and ownership limits in fintech and land: PSP-Standard licences are reserved for Ghanaians; all data controllers must register with the DPC; non-citizens cannot hold land leases above 50 years at a time. Title diligence through the Lands Commission is essential. source

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- Real Estate Agency Act, 2020 (Act 1047): anyone who, for a fee, lists, markets, sells, buys, rents or leases property on behalf of others must be licensed by the Real Estate Agency Council as a real estate broker or agent. The Council keeps a transaction database and works with the Financial Intelligence Centre on anti-money-laundering compliance. source
- 24-Hour Economy Authority Act (assented 19 Feb 2026) creates the authority that coordinates 24H+ incentives. The published 24H+ package (Aug 2025) includes import-tax exemptions on manufacturing machinery and some inputs, CIT reductions for two- and three-shift operations, priority power and water access for three-shift operators, and a local value-addition rebate (G-LVAR). President Mahama has proposed duty- and tax-free import of expansion and retooling equipment for factories registered under the initiative. Confirm which measures have been enacted in tax law. source · source 2
- The Electronic Transfer Levy (E-Levy, 1%) on mobile money and electronic transfers was abolished by the Electronic Transfer Levy Repeal Bill 2025, approved by Parliament on 26 March 2025. source

- Port-centric logistics: container traffic is growing at double digits and Tema is congested, while the US$308m Boankra inland terminal is behind schedule and seeking funding. Opportunities include off-dock container yards, bonded warehousing, inland logistics and transit corridors to Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger. source

Who is who in this sector (8)

Bank of Ghana – FinTech & Innovation Office Licenses and supervises e-money issuers, PSPs and digital credit providers; runs the regulatory sandbox and publishes monthly e-money statistics source

Telecel Ghana / AT Ghana second and third mobile operators (20.72% and 6.77% of mobile voice subscriptions, June 2026), each with a BoG-licensed mobile-money affiliate source

Ghana Investment Promotion Authority (GIPA) Successor to GIPC under Act 1173; registers foreign-participation enterprises, runs the one-stop shop and investor grievance mechanism source

Ghana Free Zones Authority Licenses free-zone enterprises and runs the Tema Export Processing Zone, with offices in Tema, Takoradi and Kumasi source

MTN Ghana / MobileMoney Ltd Dominant mobile operator (80.10% of mobile data subscriptions, June 2026); MobileMoney Ltd is a BoG-licensed Dedicated Electronic Money Issuer source

Hubtel, Paystack Ghana, Flutterwave, eTranzact, Cellulant Examples of BoG-approved PSP-Enhanced licensees in merchant acquiring, gateways and payment processing source

24-Hour Economy Authority (24H+) Statutory body (Feb 2026) coordinating multi-shift incentives, energy, logistics and regulatory facilitation source

Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority / Meridian Port Services GPHA owns and regulates the Tema and Takoradi ports, leads the Keta port project and co-develops Boankra with the Ghana Shippers' Authority. MPS (a GPHA/AGL/APM Terminals joint venture) operates Tema Terminal 3 and is expanding its capacity to 3.0m TEU. source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – FinTech statistics (monthly e-money data), Ghana Statistical Service – homepage / release calendar, National Communications Authority – reports & statistical bulletins, Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority – news, 24-Hour Economy Secretariat / Authority, Ghana Investment Promotion Authority.

DATES TO WATCH

What could move the numbers next

Mid-November 2026
October inflation (Ghana Statistical Service)

Early November 2026 (expected)
2027 Budget Statement (Ministry of Finance)

16–18 November 2026
Bank of Ghana Monetary Policy Committee decision

December 2026
Q3 2026 GDP (Ghana Statistical Service)

Late December 2026
Electricity tariffs for Q1 2027 (PURC)

30 December 2026
EU Deforestation Regulation applies to cocoa exports

HOW THIS REPORT STAYS CURRENT

Checked every week, confirmed by a person

Live economic data
Growth, inflation, the policy rate and exports update by themselves when the Bank of Ghana and the Ghana Statistical Service publish new figures.

Every source re-opened weekly
Each week our system opens every source behind every figure and the regulators' newsrooms. If a source changes or something new is published, our team is told.

A person approves changes
Nothing in the text changes by itself. An analyst reads the new information and updates the report, and every update is listed below with its date.

Sources last checked automatically on 7 October 2026; next check 14 October 2026.

Latest updates

The first edition was published on 7 October 2026.

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Talk to the people behind this report

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